How-To Library

Informatica

Using Slack to search for Cloud Data Governance and Catalog assets

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Abstract

This article is intended for users that are familiar with Slack and want to use Slack to search and view the assets that are available in Data Governance and Catalog.

Supported Versions

- Data Governance and Catalog 2023.12.P

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Overview

Data Governance and Catalog helps you understand, analyze, interpret, and govern large volumes of data in your organization. Slack is a cloud-based cross-platform instant messaging service that helps you in communicating through text messages, file and media shares, and voice and video calls. You can now search and view assets that are available in Data Governance and Catalog from Slack using public APIs.

Why use Slack with Data Governance and Catalog?

As a governance user or data owner, you can benefit from this connection in the following ways:

- Search and use data assets for immediate business impact.
- Gain quick access to data assets in Data Governance and Catalog without leaving Slack.
- Limit catalog visibility to required or authorized collaborators only.
- Provide a single platform for consolidating internal business communication and catalog search services.

Prerequisites

Before you begin, verify that you have installed an automated workflow tool to connect Data Governance and Catalog with Slack. You can use any automated workflow tool of your choice, such as Microsoft Power Automate, a Python-based tool, or a Java-based tool.

Note: In this document, we will use Microsoft Power Automate to connect Slack workspace with Data Governance and Catalog. To simplify your experience with using Microsoft Power Automate, you can use a sample template package in the Knowledge Base article 000215559.

Configure Microsoft Power Automate

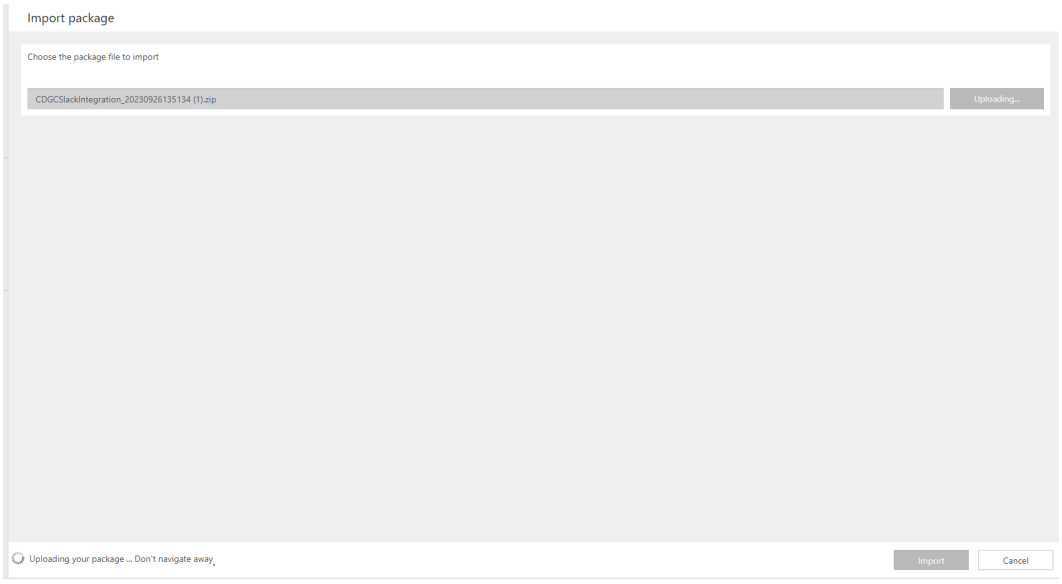
Configure Microsoft Power Automate to facilitate the data catalog search in Slack.

Creating a flow

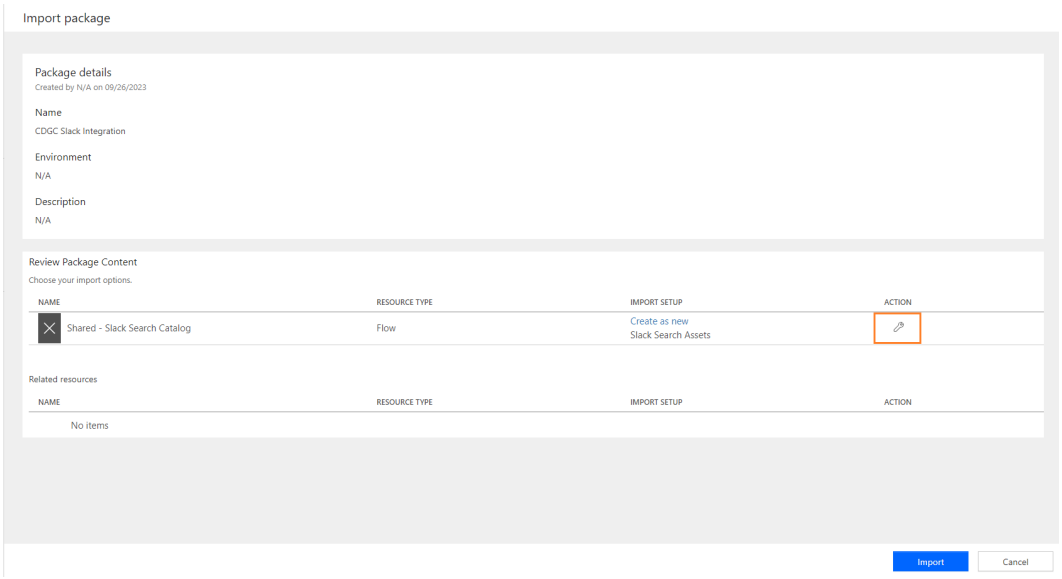
Create a flow to import the template package and configure Microsoft Power Automate in order to connect your Slack workspace with Data Governance and Catalog. A flow in Microsoft Power Automate is a set of predefined tasks or processes that run sequentially. A flow can be triggered automatically, on a schedule, or by an event such as sending a message on a Slack channel.

1. Log in to https://make.powerautomate.com.
2. Go to **My Flows** > **Import Package**.
3. On the **Import Package** page, select the package file that you want to import from your local computer and click **Upload**.

   You can also upload the sample template package that is provided by Informatica. For more information about the sample template package, see "Prerequisites" on page 2.

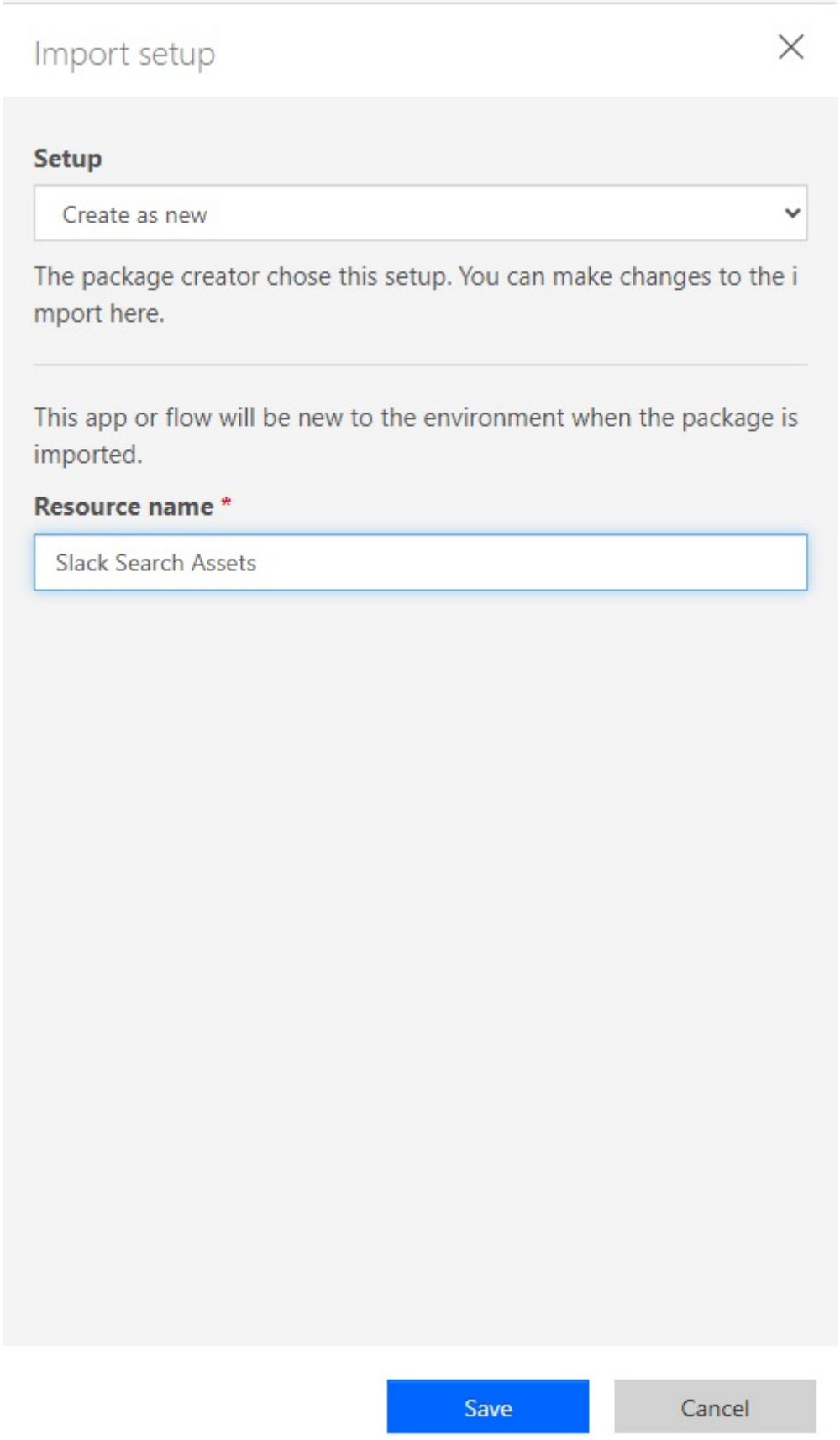


4. In the **Review Package Content** section on the **Import Package** page, click **Action**.

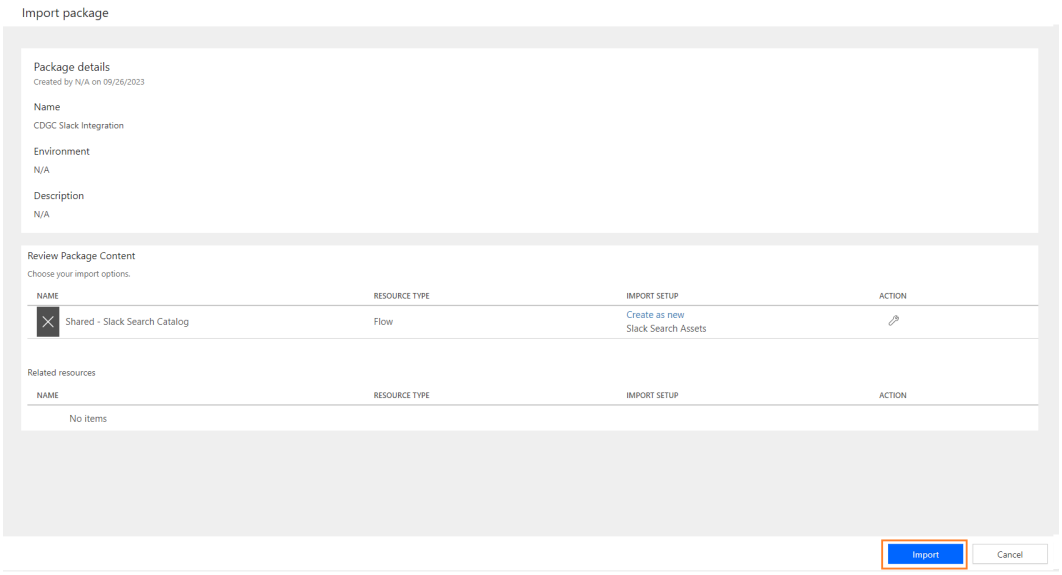


5. In the **Import setup** window, click **Setup** > **Create as new**.
6. Enter a value in the **Resource name** field on the **Import setup** dialog box. For example, add `Slack Search Assets`.

7. Click **Save**.


Import setup
Setup
Create as new
The package creator chose this setup. You can make changes to the i
mport here.
This app or flow will be new to the environment when the package is
imported.
Resource name *
Slack Search Assets
Save
Cancel

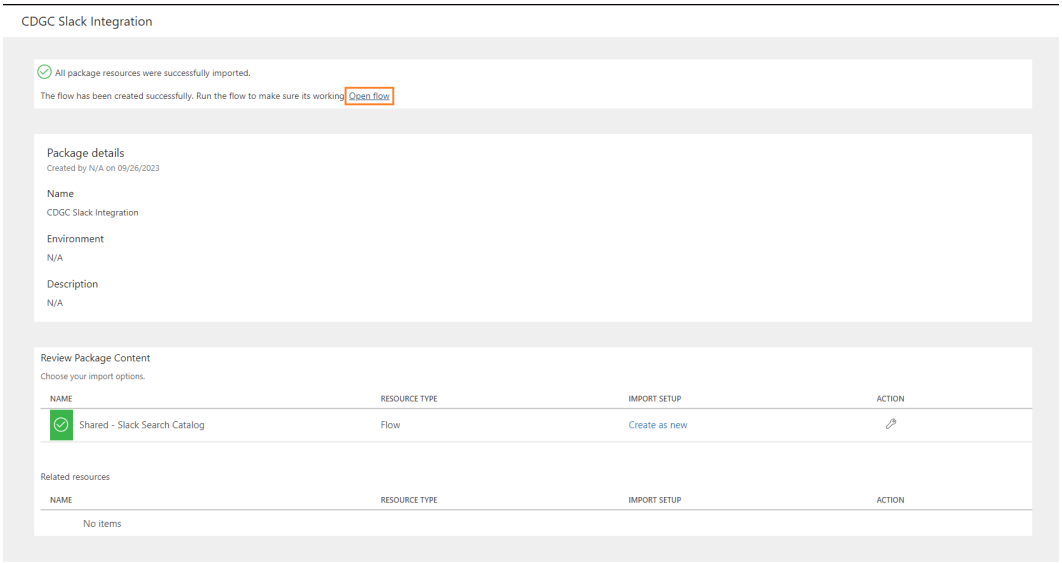
8. On the **Import package** page, click **Import** to import and create the flow in Microsoft Power Automate.



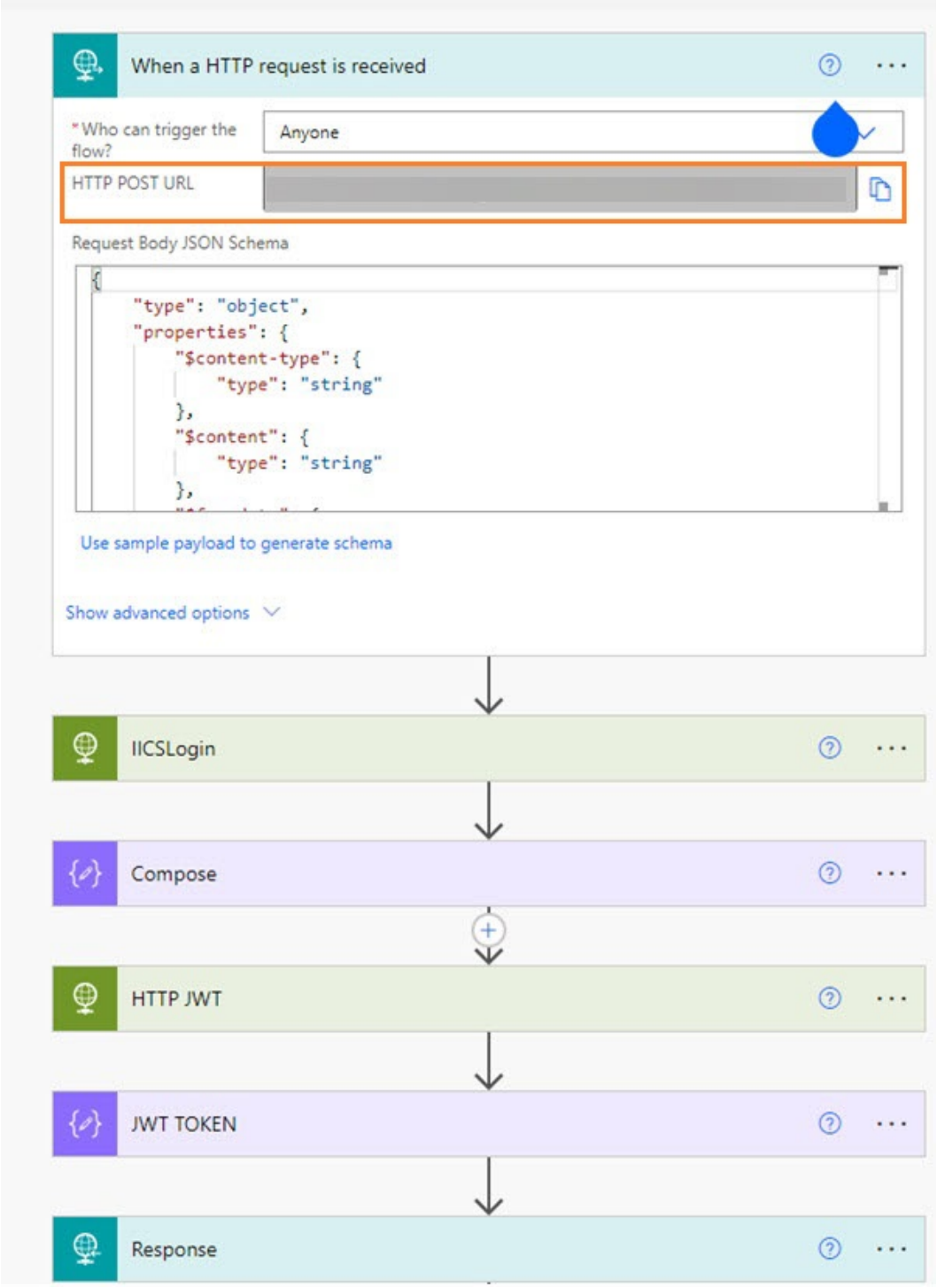
Activating the flow

Activate the flow to establish a connection between Slack and Data Governance and Catalog.

1. After you create the flow in Microsoft Power Automate, click **Open Flow** to edit the flow.

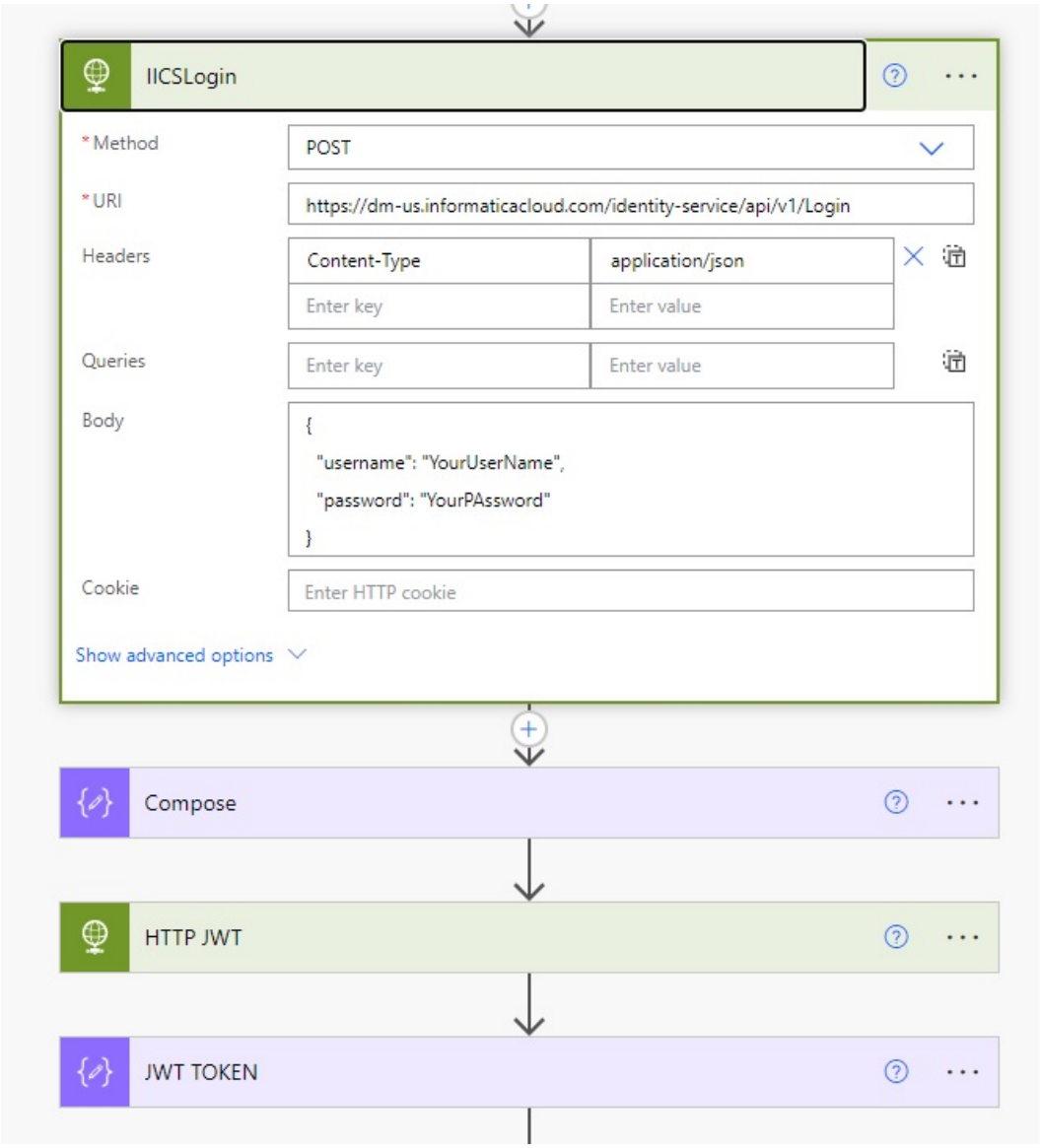


2. On the flow edit window, edit the **When a HTTP request is received** option. Copy the URL from the **HTTP POST URL** field.



You will need this URL when you create a new trigger command in Slack. For more information, see "Creating a trigger command" on page 11. This is an incoming API call that can use actions in a logic application or other API to trigger this flow.

3. In the **HTTP** section on the imported package's flow page, click the **IICSLogin** section.



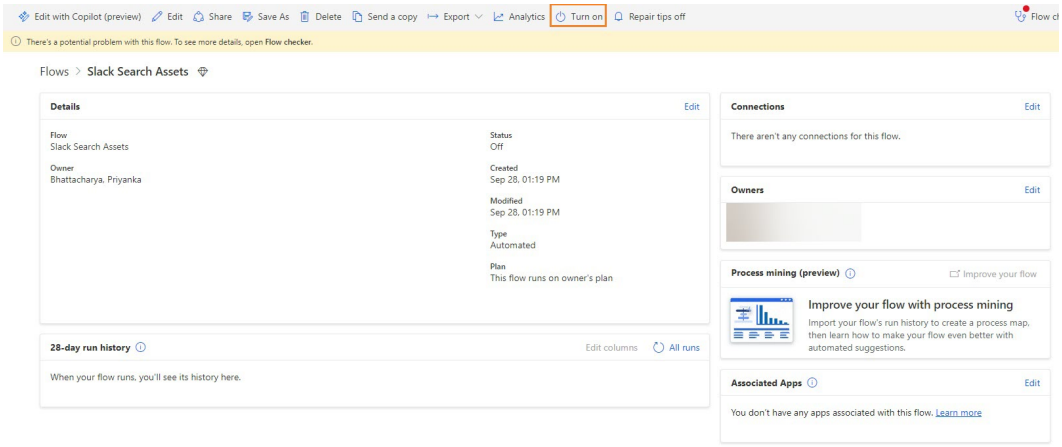
4. The following table describes the fields that you can configure in the **HTTP** section:

Field	Description
Method	Select the HTTP method to be used to invoke the web service.
URI	Enter the Informatica Intelligent Cloud Services login URL based on the region, such as `https://dm-us.informaticacloud.com`, `https://dm-em.informaticacloud.com`, `https://dm-ap.informaticacloud.com`, `https://dm-uk.informaticacloud.com`, and so on.

Field	Description
Headers	Select `Content-Type: application/json`.

Body	Enter the Informatica Intelligent Cloud Services login information.
	To specify the login information, use the following format:
	`{`
	`"username": <IICS username>`
	`"password": <IICS password>`
	`}`

5. In the **JWT Token** field, enter the JSON Web Token for your login credentials
6. Click **Save**.
7. On the **My Flows** tab, click **Turn on** to activate the imported package's flow.



The flow is activated.

Configure Slack

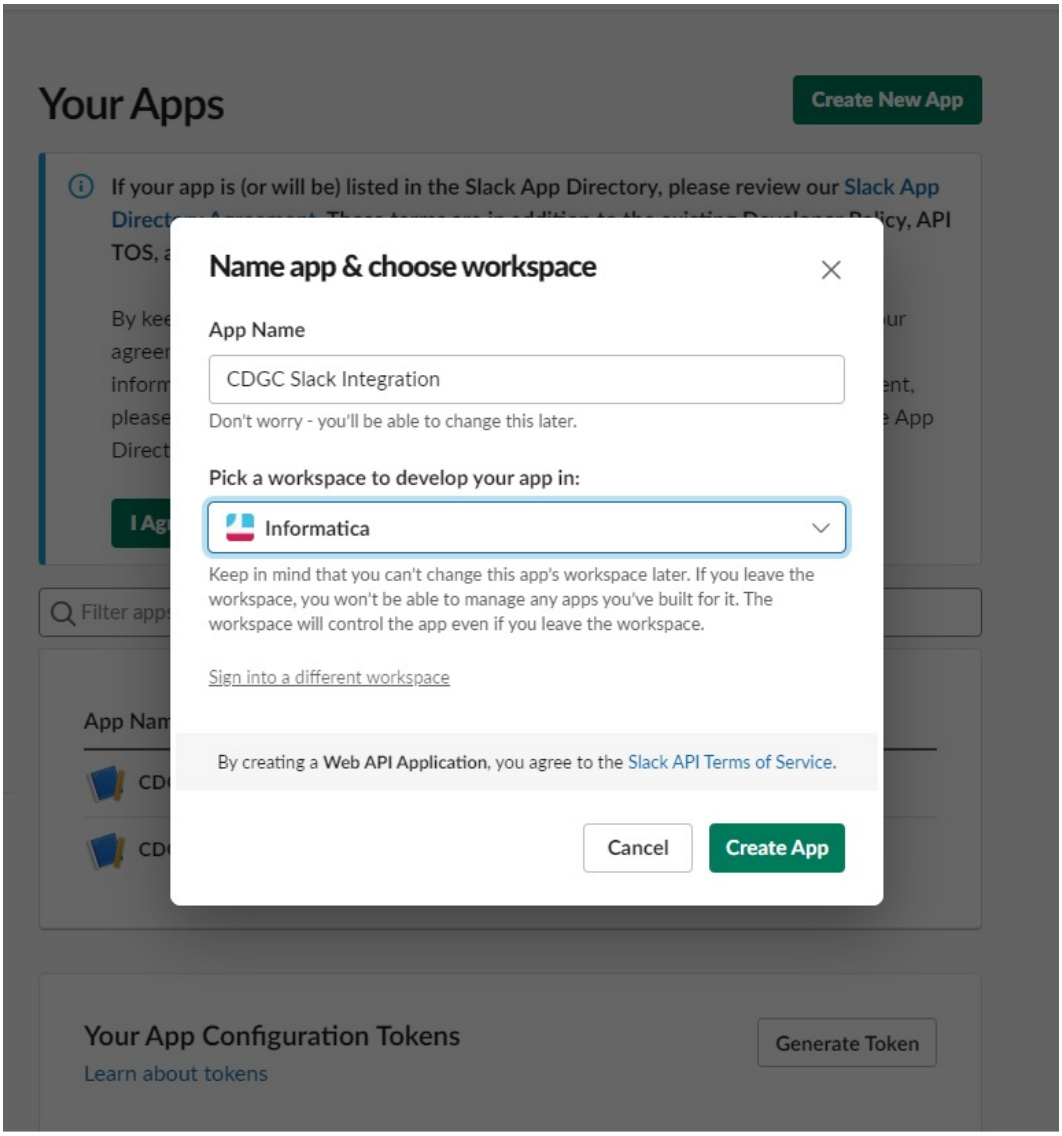
Create a Slack app to enable Data Governance and Catalog to send messages to Slack. Then, create a trigger command that you can use to invoke Data Governance and Catalog from within Slack.

Creating a Slack app for Data Governance and Catalog

Create a Slack app to enable Data Governance and Catalog to send messages to Slack.

1. Go to https://api.slack.com/apps.
2. Go to **Create New App** > **Create an App** > **From scratch**.
3. Enter a value in the **App Name** field. For example, enter `CDGC Integration`.
4. Select the workspace that you want to use to search assets from your data catalog

5. Click **Create App**.



A new app is created.

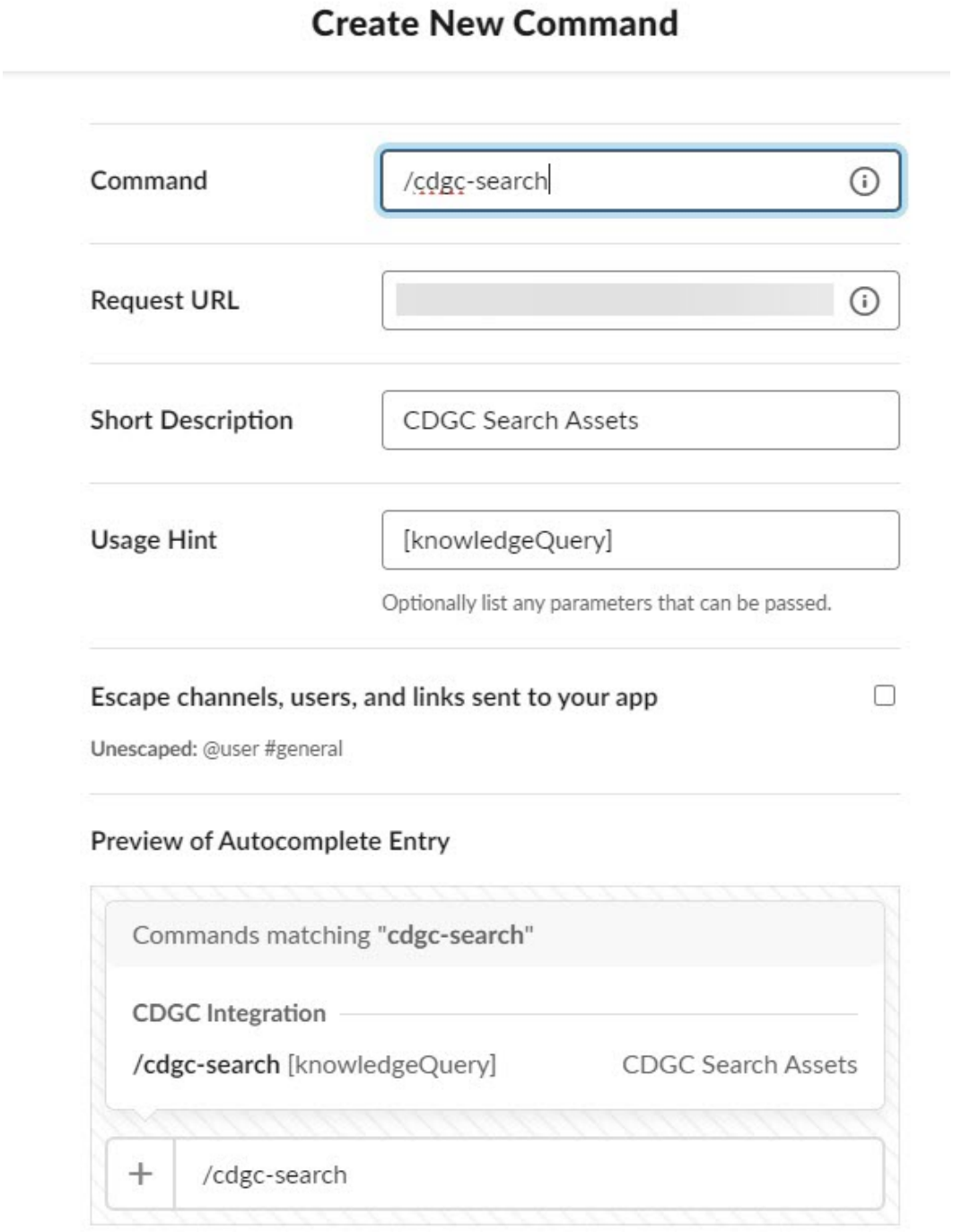
Creating a trigger command

Create a trigger command so that Slack can interact with Data Governance and Catalog.

1. Open the app that you have created and click **Slash Commands**.
2. Click **Create New Command**.

3. The following table shows the different fields in the **Create New Command** dialog:

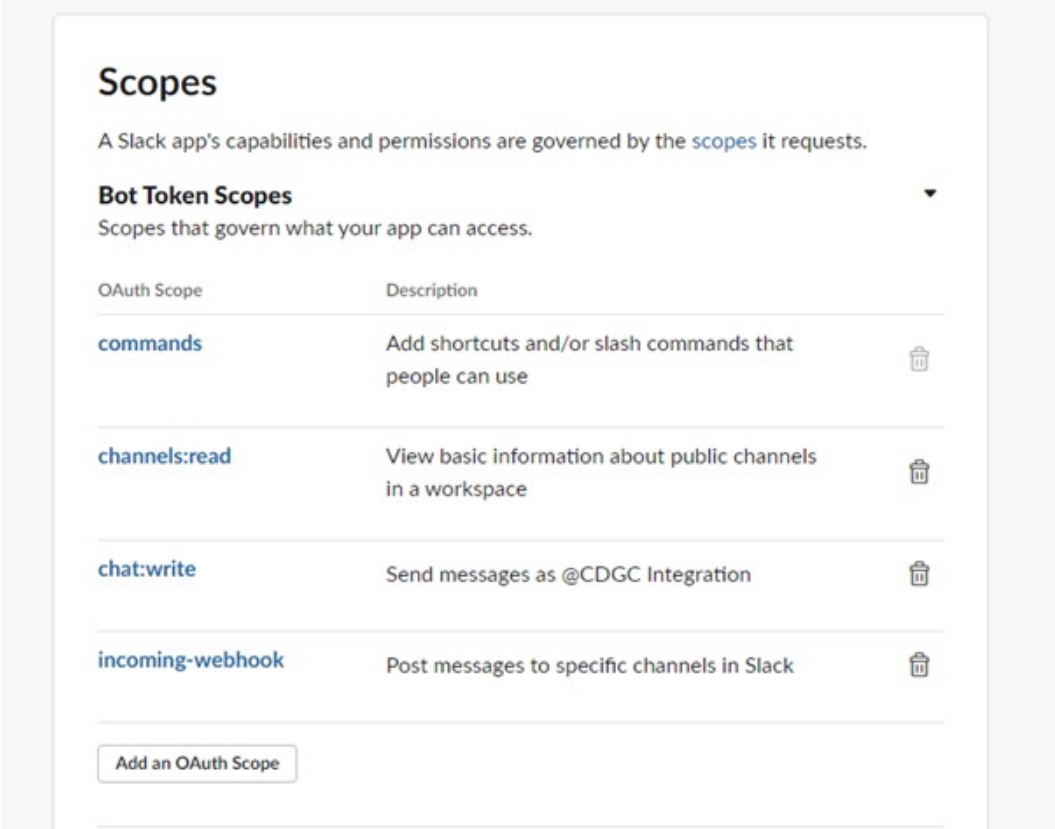
Field	Description
Command	Enter the name of the command. Use this command to invoke Data Governance and Catalog for searching and exploring assets in the catalog. For example, enter the `/cdgc-search` command.
Request URL	Enter the URL that you copied in the **HTTP POST URL** filed while creating the flow in Microsoft Power Automate, see "Creating a flow" on page 3.
Short Description	Enter the description of the command. For example, enter `CDGC Search Assets`.
Usage Hint	Enter any parameter that you can use with the command. For example, enter `[knowledgeQuery]`.



4. Click **Save** to create the trigger command.

5. Include scopes for your app to grant permissions to perform the following actions:

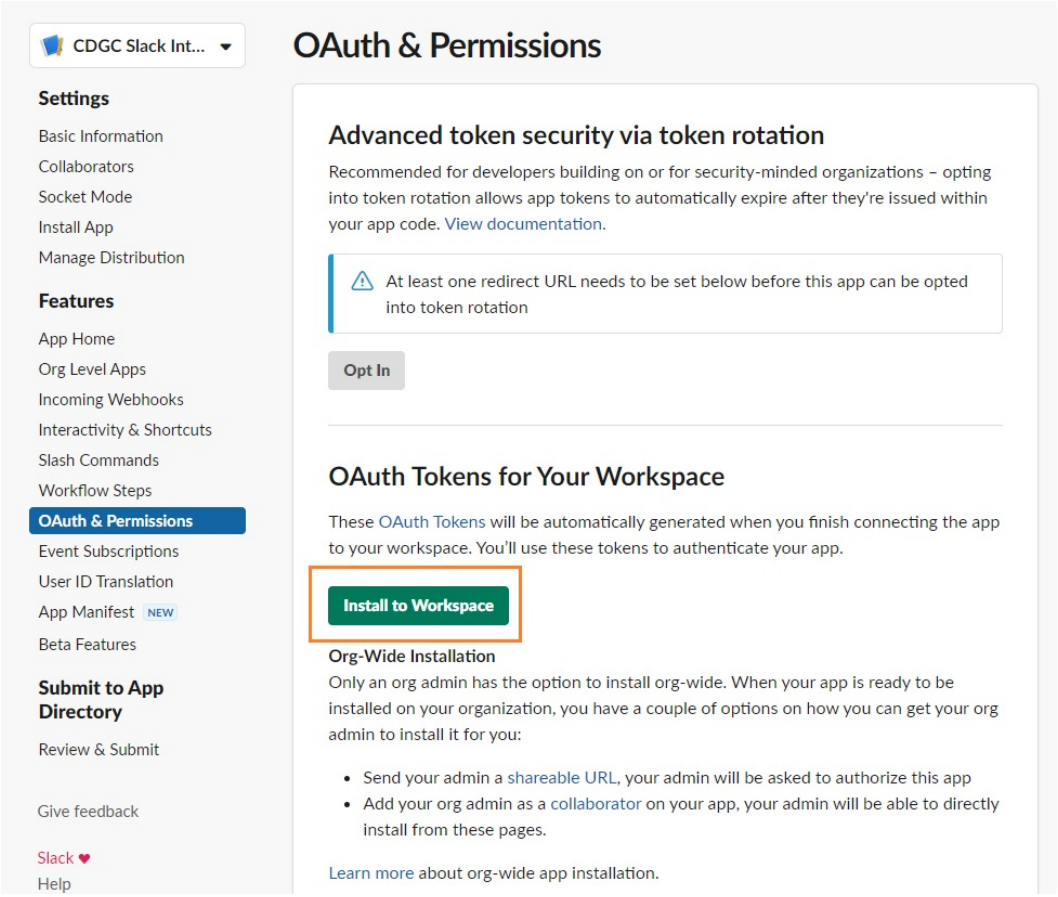
Scope	Description
channels:read	View basic information about public channels in a workspace.
chat:write	Post messages in approved channels and conversations.
command	Add shortcuts and trigger commands that you can use.
incoming-webhook	Post messages from external applications or services into Slack. It provides you with a unique URL to which you send a JSON payload with the message text and some options.



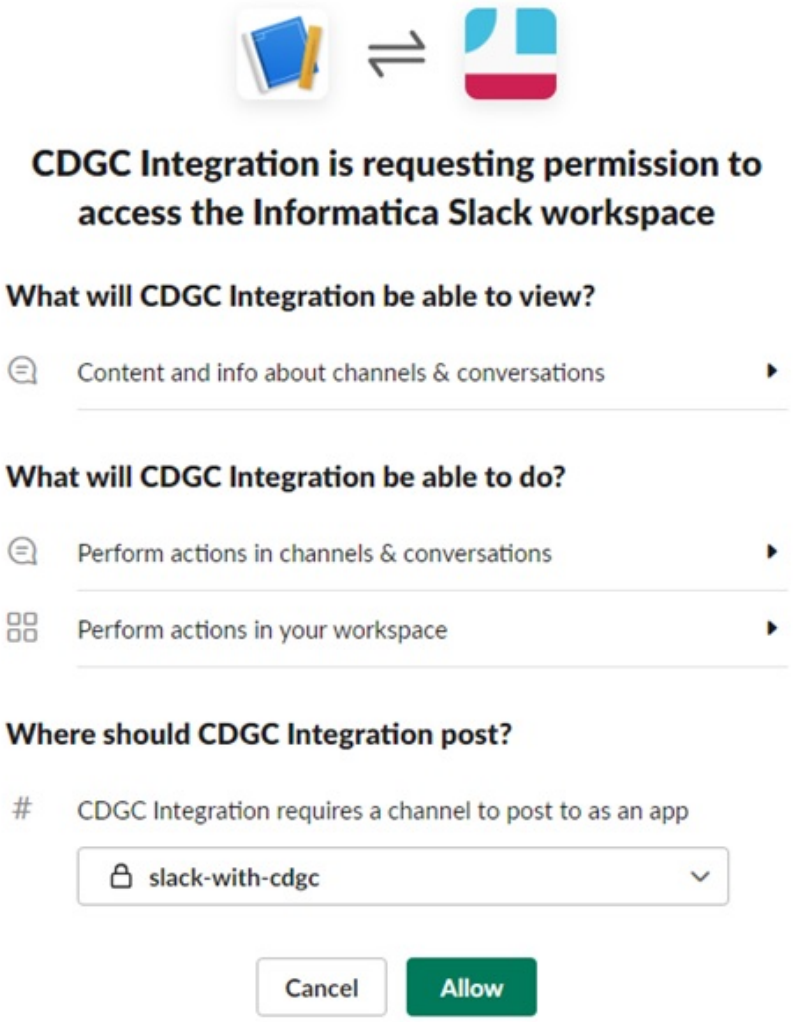
Installing the Slack app in your workspace

Install the app that you have created and select the channel where you want to view the assets.

1. Open the Slack app and click **OAuth &Permissions** > **Install to Workspace**.



2. Select a channel where you want to view the assets.

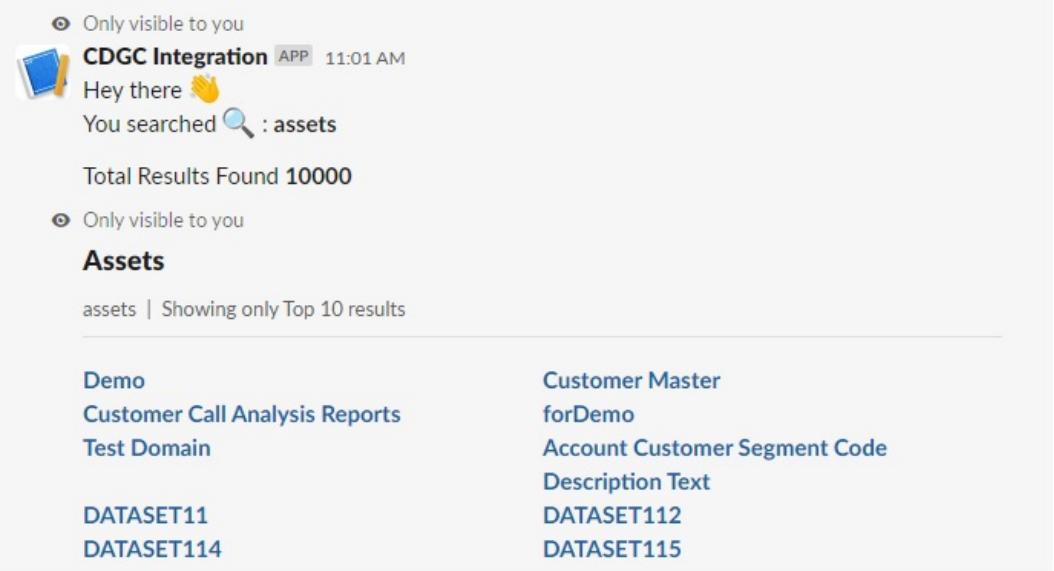


Searching and viewing catalog assets in Slack

After you have configured Slack, you can search and view business or technical assets from Data Governance and Catalog in Slack.

1. Open the Slack channel that you configured.

2. Enter the trigger command and append your search query. For example, to view the list of the data assets available in your catalog, enter `/cdgc-search assets` in the Slack channel.



Examples of viewing data assets in Slack

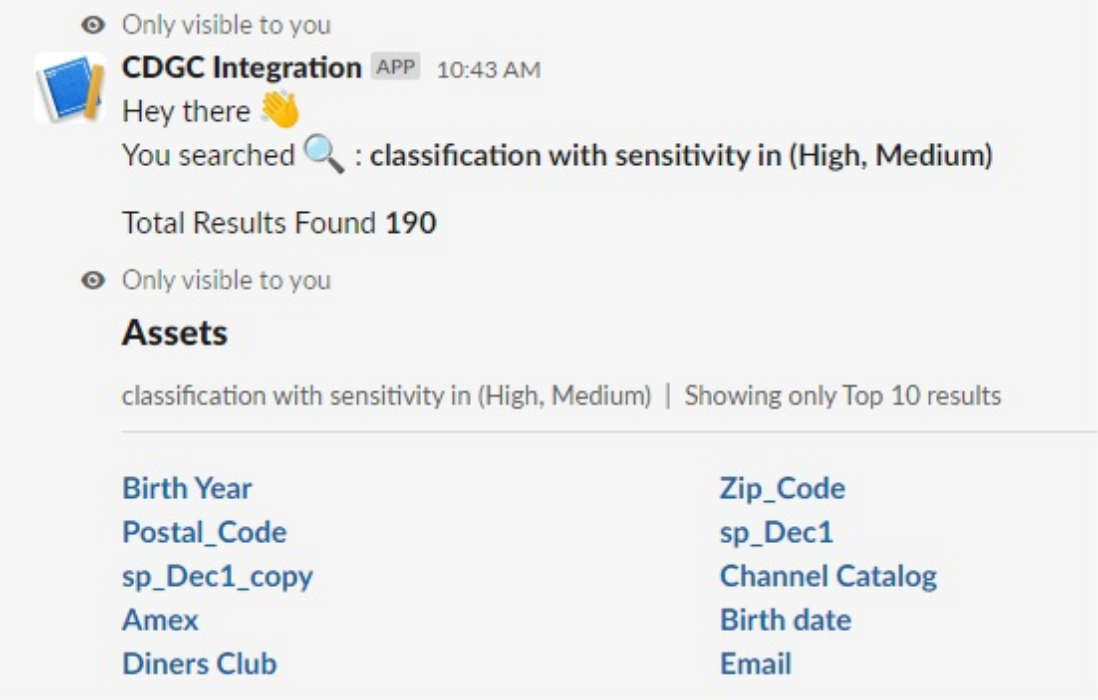
Use the search query keywords in Slack to search for data assets available in your catalog. Here are a few examples that you can try.

Example 1

To search and view all data classifications that are marked with high and medium sensitivity, enter the following command in channel:

```
/cdgc-search classification with sensitivity in (High, Medium)
```

The following image shows the search query results for data classifications with high and medium sensitivities:

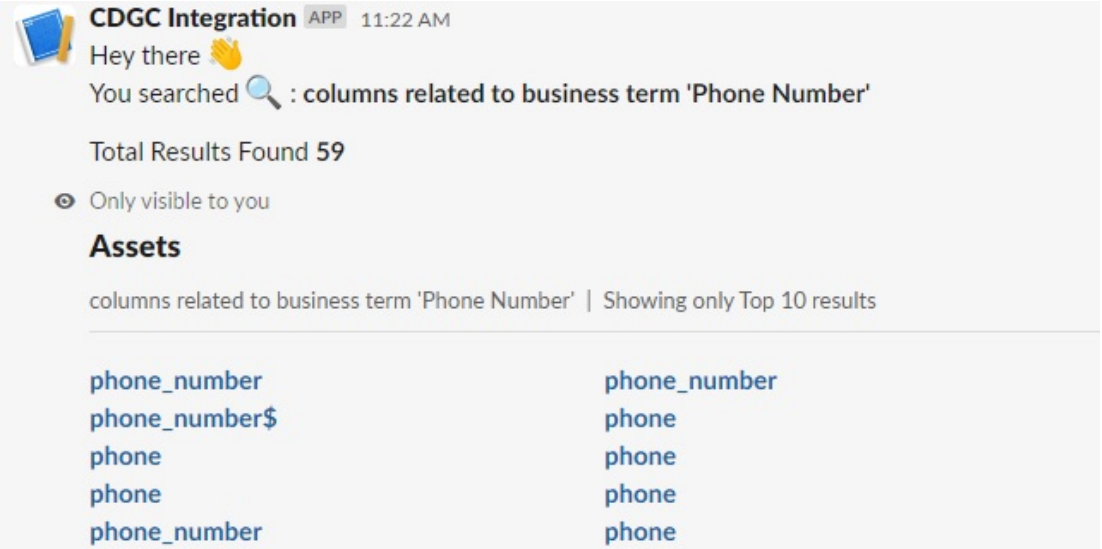


Example 2

To find all columns that are related to business term assets with the name `'Phone Number'`, enter the following command in channel:

```
/cdgc-search columns related to business term 'Phone Number'
```

The following image shows the search query results for all columns that are related to business term assets with the name `'Phone Number'`:



Author

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